

1935 ▶ 1940

1935

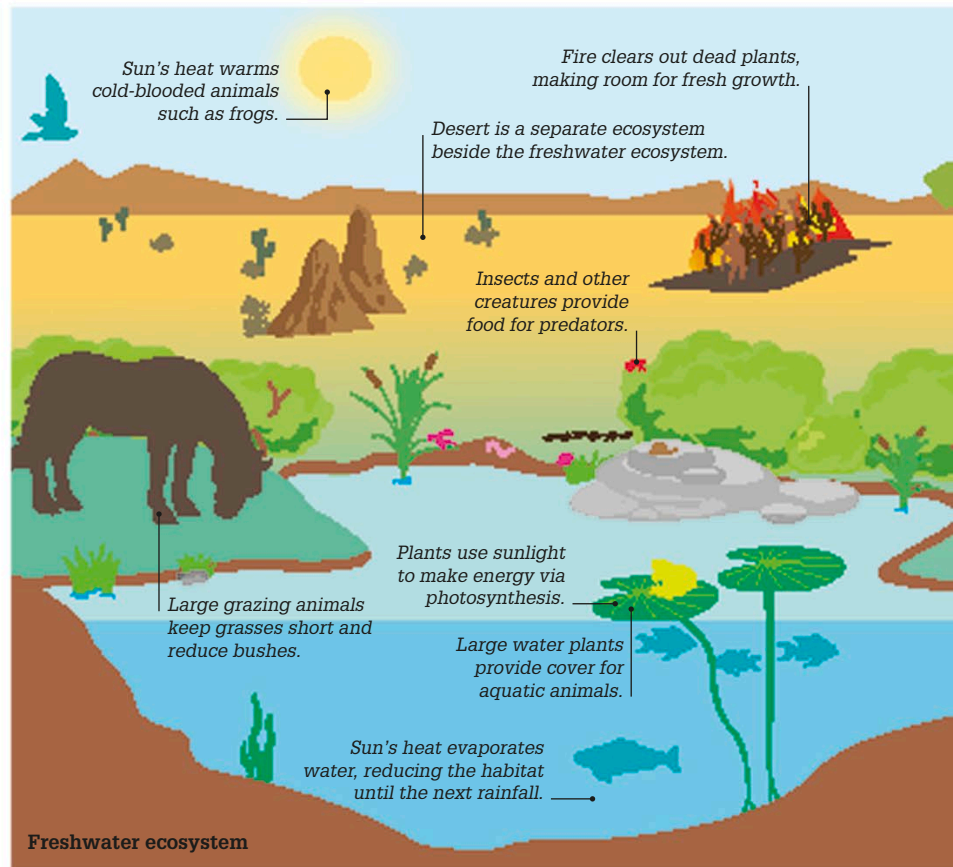
Richter scale

American physicist Charles Richter devised a scale for measuring the amount of energy released by earthquakes. Each whole number rise on the scale equals more than 31 times more energy released. Most earthquakes register under 4.0 on the scale. The most powerful measure 9.0 or above.

1935

Ecosystems

The idea of ecosystems was described by British botanist Arthur Tansley. It is a complicated set of relationships between all living things found in a particular habitat. All parts of an ecosystem are interlinked. If one changes, then the whole ecosystem may change.



1935

1935

New fabric

Nylon was made at the American chemicals company DuPont by a team led by Wallace Carothers, who was researching long chains of molecules known as polymers. Tough, light, and hard-wearing, demand for nylon quickly grew for making stockings, toothbrush bristles, and parachute canopies.

1936

Last thylacine

The last known living example of a thylacine, commonly known as the Tasmanian tiger, died in Hobart Zoo, Tasmania. The thylacine was Australia's largest meat-eating marsupial—creatures that carry and nurture their young in a pouch in their bodies. It preyed on wallabies, wombats, and birds.



1937

Radio telescope dish

American astronomer Grote Reber built a 31-ft- (9.4-m-) diameter radio telescope dish in the backyard of his home in Illinois. He was the first to map the night sky for radio waves emitted by stars and galaxies in space, and in 1939, he discovered the galaxy Cygnus A and supernova remnant Cassiopeia A.

1937

First jet engine

Aviation engineer Frank Whittle in the UK and aircraft designer Hans von Ohain in Germany independently developed jet engines, which were both first tested on the ground in 1937. Jet engines take in air, mix it with fuel, and then burn the mixture to generate rapidly expanding gases, which create thrust as they exit the engine.

